

Competitor Analysis — Dating Apps

Tinder • Hinge • Bumble • OkCupid • Badoo • Reddit Insights

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Tinder Deep Analysis – How the App Works, Business Model, User Base and SWOT

Introduction

Tinder is a location-based dating app launched in 2012 by Sean Rad, Justin Mateen and Jonathan Badeen. It introduced the “swipe” interface where users swipe right to “like” a profile or left to pass. When two users like each other, they “match” and can send messages. Tinder’s simple user interface, gamified matching and global reach have made it the most downloaded dating app globally. The platform is owned by **Match Group, Inc.**, which also operates Hinge, Match.com, OkCupid, PlentyOfFish, The League and other dating services.

How Tinder Works

Matching algorithm

- **User profiles** – Users upload photos and answer prompts. A profile displays first name, age, photos, a short bio and optional details such as occupation, education, pronouns, gender identity and sexual orientation. Tinder supports 50+ gender identities and nine sexual orientations ¹.
- **Location-based discovery** – Tinder determines a user’s approximate location via the device’s GPS and shows nearby profiles according to distance preferences set by the user (e.g., within 5–80 km). Users can filter by age range and gender.
- **Swiping** – Users swipe right to indicate interest or left to decline. If both users swipe right, they “match” and a private chat opens.
- **Matching algorithm** – Tinder’s algorithm emphasises active users. It ranks profiles based on factors such as distance, gender preferences, age, interests, anonymised photo cues and mutual likes/“nopes” ². The algorithm no longer uses a static “Elo score” and instead continually updates rankings based on recent activity and behaviour. It does not use factors like ethnicity, religion or socio-economic status ². In 2025 the company began piloting an **AI-enabled discovery experience** that uses a user’s photos and responses to dynamic questions to generate curated daily matches ³.

Key features

Feature	Description	Notes
Matches & Messaging	Only matched users can message each other. Messages appear in a chronological chat. Users can send GIFs, voice notes, video messages and share music via Spotify.	Free tier allows limited likes per day; premium tiers remove this cap.

Feature	Description	Notes
Passport	Allows users to change their location and swipe in other cities or countries. Included in paid plans.	
Rewind	Lets users undo their most recent swipe if they accidentally swiped left. Paid feature.	
Super Like & Boost	Pay-per-use features that notify a recipient they have been “Super Liked” and temporarily place a user’s profile at the front of others’ feeds.	
Explore	Introduced in 2021, Explore offers themed spaces (e.g., Vibes, Swipe Surge, Festival Mode, Music Mode) so users can discover matches with similar interests.	
Double Date	Launched in Europe in 2025, Double Date lets users team up with a friend and match with other pairs. Roughly 90 % of Double Date profiles are users under 29 and women using the feature are three times more likely to swipe right on a pair than on an individual ⁴ . This feature aims to make dating more social and will roll out globally ⁵ .	
The Game Game	A 2025 experimental voice-based feature that allowed users to “practice flirting” with an AI date. Around 750 000 users tried it in April 2025 ⁶ .	
Interactive Matching	A pilot in New Zealand (2025) that uses AI to generate high-quality daily match suggestions ⁷ .	
Face Check & Photo Verification	Safety feature requiring a video selfie to confirm that the user matches their profile photos. Tinder launched Face Check™ in India in October 2025, requiring new users to complete a mandatory video selfie to eliminate bots ⁸ .	
Behaviour warnings	Tinder uses machine-learning systems like “ Are You Sure? ” and “ Does This Bother You? ” to detect offensive messages. If a message may be inappropriate, the sender receives a prompt to reconsider before sending ⁹ . In February 2023 Tinder introduced a warning system covering authenticity, respect and inclusivity; it alerts users when they violate community guidelines and encourages them to change their behaviour ¹⁰ .	
Safety Center & ID Verification	Users can tap a shield icon to access safety tips and resources. The app also offers ID verification in some markets.	
Travel Mode & Incognito Mode	Travel Mode (for LGBTQIA+ users) alerts users when they enter countries where same-sex relationships are criminalised. Incognito Mode lets subscribers browse without appearing in other users’ decks.	

Feature	Description	Notes
Swipe Night & Festival Mode	Interactive events or story games (Swipe Night) and event-specific matching (Festival Mode) to spur engagement.	

Business Model – How Tinder Makes Money

Tinder operates a **freemium** model. The app is free to download and use, but monetises via subscriptions, à-la-carte purchases and advertising. According to Match Group's 2024 Form 10-K, Tinder had more than **10 million payers** by Q4 2023 ¹¹.

Subscription tiers (2025 pricing)

Tinder offers three main subscription plans with dynamic pricing that varies by country, age and length of commitment (monthly vs six-month plans). Prices below reflect typical U.S. monthly pricing in early 2025 ¹²:

Plan	Approximate price (per month)	Features
Tinder Plus	≈ US\$24.99 (or US\$16.66/month for a six-month plan) ¹²	Unlimited likes, Passport (change location), Rewind, no ads and one Super Like per week.
Tinder Gold	≈ US\$39.99/month (US\$23.33/month for a six-month plan) ¹²	Includes all Plus features plus Top Picks , ability to see who liked you, five Super Likes per week and one Boost per month.
Tinder Platinum	≈ US\$49.99/month (US\$29.99/month for a six-month plan) ¹³	Adds messaging before a match ("Priority Likes"), ability to prioritise likes in others' feed and see likes sent over the past week.
Tinder Select (premium)	US\$499/month (invite-only) ¹³	Offers exclusive features such as personalised matchmaking and a curated high-end experience.

Subscriptions also allow users to hide ads and access advanced filters. Tinder frequently tests weekly plans and promotional discounts; pricing may vary by region and user activity (personalised pricing). In 2024 the European Commission found that Tinder offered personalised discounts without informing users; the company agreed to disclose that discounts are personalised and explain why users are offered specific prices ¹⁴.

À-la-carte and advertising

- **Boosts and Super Likes** – Users can buy Boosts (positions profile at the front of others' queues for ~30 minutes) and Super Likes individually or in packs. Prices vary, typically US\$4.99–9.99.
- **Top Picks** – Free tier shows a limited number of curated profiles daily; subscribers can view more.
- **Advertising** – Free users see ads between swipes. Match Group classifies revenue from ads as **indirect revenue**. Although the company does not break out ad revenue for Tinder specifically,

prepared remarks for Q1 2025 noted that indirect revenue reached a record level driven by increased advertising spend ¹⁵ .

Revenue performance

- **FY 2024** – Tinder generated **US\$1.9 billion** in direct revenue, a 1 % increase year-over-year ¹⁶ . Average revenue per payer (RPP) was **US\$16.68**, while payers declined 7 % to **9.7 million** ¹⁶ . This slowdown reflected softness in user growth and monetisation.
- **Q1 2025** – Tinder’s direct revenue was **US\$447 million**, down 7 % year-over-year; payers declined 6 % to **9.1 million** and RPP fell slightly to **US\$16.38** ¹⁷ . Match Group stated that Tinder’s monthly active users declined 9 % year-over-year ¹⁸ .
- **Q2 2025** – Tinder’s direct revenue was **US\$461 million**, down 4 % year-over-year. Payers declined 7 % to **9.0 million**, but RPP grew 3 % to **US\$17.14** ¹⁹ . Operating income margin was 46 % ¹⁹ .

Tinder remains Match Group’s largest brand; however, in 2025 growth has slowed and the company is undergoing a multi-phase turnaround to revitalise the product, including AI-driven features and safety initiatives ²⁰ .

User Base and Demographics

Downloads and reach

- Tinder has been downloaded **over 630 million** times globally and has generated **over 100 billion matches** ²¹ .
- The app is available in **190 countries** and **45 languages** ²¹ .
- Tinder recorded **6.8 billion LGBTQIA+ matches** and offers more than **50 gender identities** ¹ .

Monthly active users (MAUs) and payers

- Tinder does not publicly disclose precise MAU counts. **Business of Apps** estimates that the platform had around **60 million monthly active users** in 2024 ²² . Other research agencies such as **DemandSage** and **Resourcera** report between **60–75 million** monthly users and **9.6 million** paid subscribers worldwide in 2024–2025 ²³ ²⁴ . Match Group’s prepared remarks disclosed that Tinder’s MAUs declined 9 % year-over-year in Q1 2025 ¹⁸ , suggesting current MAUs may be around **55 million**.
- By geography, the U.S. is Tinder’s largest market with roughly **7.8 million** users, followed by the U.K., Brazil and other countries ²⁵ .

Demographics

Demographic	Percentage / Characteristics	Source
Age	Approximately 35.7 % of users are aged 18–24, 25.5 % are 25–34, 20.4 % are 35–44, 8.2 % are 45–54 and 10.2 % are 55+ ²⁶ . Tinder’s pressroom says nearly 60 % of users are aged 18–30 ²¹ .	DemandSage / Tinder pressroom
Gender	Approximately 75 % male, 24 % female and 1 % non-binary ²⁷ .	DemandSage

Demographic	Percentage / Characteristics	Source
Income	Around 30 % of users earn US\$60–80k annually, 22 % earn US\$80–100k, 18 % earn >US\$100k and 30 % earn <US\$60k ²⁸ .	DemandSage
Sexual orientation	Tinder supports heterosexual, homosexual and LGBTQIA+ orientations; 6.8 billion LGBTQIA+ matches have been made ¹ .	Tinder pressroom
Activity	Users log in on average 4 times per day , spend about 90 minutes per day on the app and collectively make 1.6 billion swipes per day ²⁹ ²³ .	Resourcera/ DemandSage
Match rates	Women swipe right on about 12 % of profiles, while men swipe right on about 60 % of profiles ²⁹ .	Resourcera

Safety and Trust Features

Tinder has faced criticism for safety issues such as fake profiles, harassment and scams. In response, the company has rolled out numerous features and policies:

1. **Photo Verification and Face Check™** – Users must take a video selfie; if it matches uploaded photos they receive a “Photo Verified” badge. In 2025, Tinder launched Face Check™ in India to fight bots ³⁰ and rolled it out in California ³¹ .
2. **Machine-learning warnings** – “Does This Bother You?” and “Are You Sure?” detect potentially harmful messages and prompt users to rethink sending them ⁹ .
3. **User behaviour warnings** – Introduced in 2023, these warnings classify violations into authenticity, respect and inclusivity. Repeated violations can lead to account removal ³² .
4. **Safety Center and support** – Users can access tips, contact local authorities and learn about consent via a dedicated hub. Tinder provides emergency assistance features in some regions.
5. **Travel Mode** – Alerts LGBTQIA+ users when they enter countries with laws against same-sex relationships and hides their profile by default.
6. **Blocking and reporting** – Users can block or unmatched with anyone and report abuse or suspicious profiles directly in the app.
7. **Collaboration with World ID** – In 2025 Tinder announced a partnership with World ID to integrate user authenticity checks, further reducing fake accounts ³³ .

These efforts indicate that safety is a strategic priority, yet the app still faces reputational challenges due to reports of assault and harassment. The effectiveness of safety features depends on enforcement and user adoption.

Controversies and Regulatory Issues

- **Age-based pricing and personalisation** – In the U.S., Tinder settled a class-action lawsuit alleging that it charged users over 29 more for its subscription plans. In 2024 a California court approved a settlement requiring Tinder to pay **US\$17.3 million** in benefits (free Super Likes, cash payments and free subscriptions) and prohibiting it from charging users different prices based on age (except for under-21 discounts) ³⁴ . In the European Union, regulators found that Tinder offered personalised discounts without informing users; the company agreed in March 2024 to clearly disclose that discounts are personalised and explain the reasons ¹⁴ .

- **Data privacy** – In 2020 the Irish Data Protection Commission opened an inquiry into how Tinder processed users' personal data. While the investigation is ongoing, it underscores concerns about how the app handles sensitive information (location, sexual orientation, photos). Tinder states that it retains data to enforce its terms and collaborates with regulators.
- **Safety incidents** – Media reports have highlighted incidents of sexual assault and harassment linked to matches made on Tinder. Critics say the platform should do more to vet profiles and respond to reports.

Strengths and Weaknesses (SWOT)

Strengths

1. **Market leader and strong network effects** – Tinder remains the most downloaded dating app with hundreds of millions of downloads and tens of millions of active users. Its large user base creates a network effect where the app becomes more valuable as more people join.
2. **Brand recognition and cultural relevance** – Tinder's swipe has become synonymous with dating. The app appeals to Gen Z and millennials and is widely referenced in popular culture.
3. **Simple user experience** – The intuitive swipe interface reduces friction and encourages habitual use. Gamification (matches, Super Likes, limited likes for free users) keeps users engaged.
4. **Global reach and inclusivity** – Tinder is available in 190 countries, 45 languages and supports more than 50 gender identities and nine sexual orientations ²¹. It has made 6.8 billion LGBTQIA+ matches ¹.
5. **Diverse monetization streams** – Subscription tiers, pay-per-use features and advertising provide multiple revenue sources. Despite slowing growth, Tinder still generates ~US\$1.9 billion in annual direct revenue ¹⁶.
6. **Investment in AI and innovation** – The company is revitalising the product with features such as Double Date, Interactive Matching and AI-curated daily matches ²⁰, signalling a focus on improving user experience and outcomes.
7. **Robust trust & safety investments** – Tinder has launched numerous safety features including photo verification, Face Check, behaviour warnings and partnerships with World ID ³⁰ ³³.

Weaknesses

1. **Slowing growth and declining payers** – Tinder's payers fell from 10.4 million in 2023 to 9.7 million in 2024 ¹⁶, and to **9.0 million** by Q2 2025 ¹⁹. Direct revenue growth has stalled, indicating saturation or monetization challenges.
2. **Gender imbalance** – Approximately **75 %** of users are male ²⁷. This imbalance can lead to poorer match quality for women and may deter female users.
3. **Reputation and safety concerns** – Reports of harassment, catfishing and sexual assault have damaged Tinder's reputation. Although the company has introduced safety features, users may remain cautious.
4. **Pricing complaints and personalisation issues** – Age-based pricing and personalised discount practices have resulted in legal settlements and regulatory scrutiny ³⁴ ¹⁴. The high cost of Tinder Platinum and the invite-only Tinder Select (US\$499/month) can also be seen as exploitative.
5. **Dependence on casual dating niche** – Tinder's focus on low-pressure connections appeals largely to 18–30 year-olds. Competitors like Hinge target "intentional dating" and may attract users seeking long-term relationships.
6. **Privacy worries** – Extensive data collection (location, photos, sexual orientation) raises privacy concerns. Investigations by regulators (e.g., Ireland's DPC) create legal risk.

7. **Competition** – The dating app market is crowded (Bumble, Hinge, Badoo, Grindr). Apps with differentiated niches, such as Hinge’s relationship focus or Bumble’s female-first messaging, may siphon off users.

Conclusion

Tinder transformed online dating by introducing swipe-based matching and remains a dominant player with tens of millions of users and billions in revenue. The app’s simple design, global reach, brand recognition and inclusive options have created strong network effects. However, Tinder now faces headwinds: payer numbers and growth have declined, the user base skews male, and the brand is grappling with safety, privacy and regulatory challenges. Match Group’s 2025 turnaround plan centres on **resetting** Tinder’s culture, **revitalising** the product through AI-driven matching and social features like Double Date, and **improving trust & safety** via Face Check and behavioural warnings ²⁰. Its success will depend on whether these innovations can re-energise younger users, restore payer growth and address long-standing safety concerns while balancing profitability.

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Hinge: Executive Brief (October 13 2025)

Overview

Hinge is a relationship-oriented dating app owned by Match Group. Launched in 2012 and rebranded in 2016 with the slogan **“Designed to be deleted,”** it competes by encouraging deeper connections rather than endless swiping. Hinge operates in **190 countries** and is available in **45 + languages** ¹.

Key Metrics

Metric	2024	2025 progress	Sources
Direct revenue	US\$550 M in FY-2024 (+39 % YoY) ²	Q2-2025 revenue US\$168 M (+25 % YoY) ³ ; H2 2025 user spending shows Hinge revenue ~US\$64 M in April (+67 % vs Jan) ⁴	Match Group filings and app-spending data
Payers	1.532 M FY-2024 (+23 %) ²	1.7 M Q2-2025 (+18 % YoY) ³	Match Group 8-K and prepared remarks
Revenue per payer (RPP)	US\$29.94 FY-2024 (+13 % YoY) ²	US\$31.96 Q2-2025 (+6 %) ³	Match Group
Users	~ 30 M total users and 1.53 M paying subscribers (2024) ⁵	MAU up ~ 20 % in first half 2025 ⁶	Business of Apps; Match Group release

Product Mechanics

- **Profiles & prompts** – Each profile contains at least six photos and three written, voice or video prompts. Interactive polls and voice/video prompts added in 2024–25 give users creative ways to show personality ⁷.
- **Matching algorithm** – Hinge’s algorithm builds a personal **“taste profile”** by learning who you like and who likes you back. It uses a variation of the **Gale-Shapley stable-marriage algorithm** with machine learning to prioritise compatible matches ⁸. In March 2025 an **AI-powered Core Discovery Algorithm** rolled out, boosting matches and contact exchanges by **15 %** ⁶.
- **Standouts & Roses** – A curated Standouts feed suggests highly compatible profiles; interacting requires sending a paid **Rose**, which doubles the chance of a date ⁹.
- **Daily likes & Your Turn Limits** – Free users can send up to eight likes daily; a 2024 “Your Turn Limits” feature blocks new likes if you have eight or more unanswered matches, reducing ghosting ¹⁰.

- **Post-date feedback** – The “**We Met**” feature asks matched users if they met and whether they’d like a second date, improving the algorithm ¹¹. The **First Date Check-in** (rolled out later) also asks about safety and satisfaction ¹².
- **Verification & safety** – Video selfie verification ensures profile authenticity ¹². Users can block/report others, and Hinge publishes safety tips and uses AI moderation; however, investigative reports in 2025 raised concerns about slow removal of reported offenders ¹³.

Monetization

- **Subscription tiers** –
- **Hinge Plus (~US\$200/yr)**: unlimited likes, advanced preference filters and full access to see who liked you ⁹.
- **Hinge X (~US\$300/yr)**: adds enhanced recommendations, priority exposure (“skip the line”), unblurred Standouts and extra Roses ⁹. Prices vary by region; some markets saw monthly prices around US\$45 in early 2025 ⁴.
- **À-la-carte purchases** – Users can buy extra **Roses** (bundled at roughly US\$3 each) and **Boosts** (~US\$10/hour) to increase visibility ¹⁴.
- **Advertising** – Hinge runs limited ads; nearly all revenue is “direct” (subscriptions and purchases) ².

User Demographics

- **Gender** – Surveys suggest Hinge’s user base is roughly **60 % male / 40 % female** ¹⁵.
- **Age** – The largest cohort is ages **25–34 (≈32 %)**, followed by **18–24 (26 %)**; users older than 35 make up about 30 % ¹⁵.
- **Relationship intent** – Approximately **87 %** of Hinge users say they are looking for a serious relationship ¹⁶. The Knot’s wedding survey reported that 35 % of couples who met online and later married did so via Hinge ¹⁶.
- **Geography** – About half of users are in the U.S.; the app saw **60 %+** user growth in European markets in early 2025 ⁶ and plans to launch in Mexico and Brazil later in 2025 ¹⁷.

Strengths

1. **Sustained growth** – Revenue grew from US\$8 M (2018) to US\$550 M (2024) ¹⁸, and Q2-2025 revenue rose 25 % YoY ³. Payer growth (18 % YoY in Q2 2025) and rising RPP show strong unit economics.
2. **Differentiated experience** – Prompt-driven profiles and item-level likes encourage thoughtful interactions. AI features like Core Discovery and Prompt Feedback improve matching and engagement ⁶.
3. **Relationship-focused brand** – The “Designed to be deleted” positioning resonates with users seeking serious relationships, aligning with survey results showing high intent for long-term commitment ¹⁶.
4. **Safety investments** – Video verification, post-date check-ins, and user-reporting tools promote trust ¹².
5. **Global expansion** – Rapid growth in Europe and plans to enter Latin America signal untapped markets ¹⁷.

Weaknesses & Risks

1. **High pricing and paywall** – Subscription prices approaching US\$45/month and reliance on paid Roses/Boosts generate “rose jail” complaints, making the app feel pay-to-participate ⁴.

2. **Gender imbalance** – Male users make up roughly 60 %, potentially leading to uneven match dynamics ¹⁵ .
3. **Transparency concerns** – Hinge claims not to rank users by attractiveness, but it does not disclose weighting details, fuelling suspicion of hidden ranking mechanisms.
4. **Safety controversies** – Investigations in 2025 highlighted instances where known offenders remained on the app despite multiple reports ¹³ ; reputational and regulatory risks remain.
5. **Competition** – Hinge competes with larger players (Tinder, Bumble, niche apps). Maintaining growth may be harder as market saturates.

Outlook

Hinge is Match Group's fastest-growing asset, combining a thoughtful user experience with innovative monetization. Continued investment in AI-driven discovery, international expansion and stronger safety protocols will be critical to sustaining momentum while addressing concerns over pricing and user trust.

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Bumble Dating App — Deep Analysis (2025)

Overview

Bumble is a U.S.-based dating and social-networking app founded by Whitney Wolfe Herd in 2014 after she left Tinder. Bumble positions itself as a woman-first alternative to swipe-based dating: in heterosexual matches, women must send the first message within 24 hours or the match disappears ¹. The company also operates **Bumble BFF** for finding platonic friends and **Bumble Bizz** for professional networking. Bumble is available in more than **150 countries** and supports users in **over 45 languages** ². As of 2024 the app has around **50 million users** and roughly **2.8 million paying subscribers** ³, making it one of the world's largest dating platforms.

How Bumble Works

Matching and messaging mechanics

- **Swiping and matches** – Users swipe right to like a profile and left to pass, similar to Tinder. When two users swipe right on each other they form a match.
- **Women-first messaging** – In heterosexual matches, **only the woman can send the first message**, and she has **24 hours** to do so or the match expires ¹. Men cannot start the conversation but can extend the 24-hour time limit once per day. In same-sex or non-binary matches either person can message first.
- **BFF and Bizz modes** – Bumble allows users to switch to **BFF** (2016) to find friends and **Bizz** (2017) for professional networking ¹. These modes use similar swiping mechanics but remove gender rules.
- **Filters and profiles** – Users create profiles with photos, basic personal information and optional prompts. They can apply filters for age, distance, gender, religion and political views. In 2024 Bumble's redesign required at least **four photos**, added **"Opening Moves"** (allowing women to pick a question for their first message) and **"Dating Intentions"** badges so users can signal their relationship goals ⁴. The update also introduced a personalized **For You** page with algorithmically curated matches ⁴.
- **Stand-alone modes and features** – Bumble introduced various quality-of-life tools: **Beeline** shows profiles that have already liked you (paid feature); **Extend** adds 24 hours to a match timer; **Rematch** revives expired matches; **Travel Mode** lets users swipe in other locations; and **Incognito Mode** (premium) hides you except when you like someone ⁵. Daily swipes for free users are capped, and features such as unlimited swipes, advanced filters, rematches and access to the Beeline require a paid subscription ⁶.

Algorithm and discovery

Public information about Bumble's proprietary algorithm is limited. Match suggestions are primarily based on **geographic proximity, gender and age preferences**, swiping behaviour and profile completeness. Bumble's 2024 redesign included a **new algorithm** to deliver more relevant matches and a **personalized For You page** ⁴. The company has experimented with **AI-powered features** for flagging inappropriate messages and providing conversation prompts ⁷. However, Bumble has not published detailed technical documentation of its ranking system.

Monetization and Business Model

Freemium tiers

Bumble operates a **freemium** model: the core swiping and matching experience is free, but a suite of premium features and in-app purchases generate the majority of revenue. The company offers several subscription tiers:

Tier (2025)	Key Features	Price examples
Bumble Boost	Extend or rematch expired matches; see who has liked you (Beeline) and send unlimited swipes.	Pricing varies by location; older plans were around US \$14.99/month (subject to dynamic pricing).
Bumble Premium	Includes all Boost benefits plus advanced filters (e.g., education level), Travel Mode , Incognito Mode , ability to see everyone who liked you , unlimited swipes and SuperSwipes to show extra interest ⁵ .	US \$29.99/month, \$59.99 for three months, or \$99.99 for six months ⁵ .
Bumble Premium+	An enhanced tier introduced in 2023–2024 offering “Backtrack” , priority in people’s stacks, “Spotlight” to jump to the front of the queue, unlimited SuperSwipes , and the ability to see everyone who liked you . Some plans also offer weekly options.	Daily plans around \$4.99/day or weekly plans \$12.99/week (prices vary).

In addition to subscriptions, Bumble sells **pay-per-use “SuperSwipes” and “Spotlight” boosts**, which increase profile visibility for a limited time ⁵. These microtransactions appeal to users who do not want a full subscription but want occasional visibility boosts.

Financial performance

Bumble’s revenue and paying-user base have grown rapidly since its initial public offering (IPO) in 2021, but growth slowed in 2024–2025. According to **Business of Apps**, Bumble generated **\$866 million in revenue in 2024** (up 2% from 2023) and had **2.8 million paying users** among **50 million total users** ³. The table below summarises revenue and paying-user figures from public sources:

Year	Total revenue (Bumble, \$M)	Total users (M)	Paying users (M)	Source
2019	488	9.4	0.8	Business of Apps revenue timeline and paying-user data ³
2020	542	12.3	1.3	Business of Apps ³
2021	570	20	1.7	Business of Apps ³
2022	694	28	2.2	Business of Apps ³

Year	Total revenue (Bumble, \$M)	Total users (M)	Paying users (M)	Source
2023	844	38	2.5	Business of Apps ³
2024	866	50	2.8	Business of Apps ³

The figures above are consolidated for Bumble Inc., including its dating brands (Bumble Date, BFF, Bizz and Badoo). Quarterly results from the company's investor presentations provide more granular insight:

- **Q4 2024** – Total revenue **\$261.6 million** (down 4% year-over-year); **Bumble App revenue \$212.4 million; total paying users 4.2 million** (up 5%); **Bumble App paying users 2.8 million; average revenue per paying user (ARPPU) \$20.58; net earnings \$9.3 million and adjusted EBITDA \$72.5 million** ⁸. These results suggest Bumble still delivered a profit in the fourth quarter but experienced declining revenue and ARPPU compared with earlier periods.
- **Q2 2025** – Total revenue **\$248.2 million** (down 8% year-on-year); **Bumble App revenue \$201.4 million; total paying users 3.8 million** (down 9%); **Bumble App paying users 2.5 million** (down 11%); **ARPPU \$21.69** (up 1%); the company reported a **net loss of \$367 million** due to a non-cash impairment and **adjusted EBITDA of \$94.6 million** (26% margin) ⁹. The decline in paying users and revenue indicates competitive pressure and user churn.

Geographic and segment revenue

Approximately **40 % of Bumble's revenue comes from the United States** and around **10 % from the United Kingdom** ³. Bumble also owns the legacy app **Badoo**, which is popular in Europe and Latin America, but most of Bumble's revenue and user growth comes from the Bumble app and its BFF/ Bizz spin-offs.

User Base and Demographics

Total users and paying users

- **Total users:** Around **50 million** users worldwide in 2024 ³. Some sources report **over 50 million active users** in 2024 ¹⁰.
- **Paying users:** Approximately **2.8 million paying subscribers** in 2024 ³. According to a 2023 summary, only **4.6% of Bumble's users pay** for premium features ¹¹, illustrating a heavy reliance on the free tier.
- **Regional distribution:** Helplama estimates roughly **4.3 million U.S. users** and a **26.04% U.S. market share** for Bumble in 2024 ¹⁰. About **70 % of revenue comes from the U.S.** ¹².

Age and gender

Reliable demographic data on dating apps is limited because companies rarely publish official breakdowns. Secondary sources suggest Bumble skews younger and male-dominant:

- **Age distribution:** Business of Apps cites Bumble's own disclosures that **72 % of users are under 35** ². DouLike notes an average user age of **26** and that **70 % are under 35** ¹². The largest cohort is 25–34-year-olds, followed by 18–24-year-olds.
- **Gender ratio:** Estimates vary. Helplama reports that **46.2 % of Bumble users are female**, implying a roughly **3:1 male-to-female ratio** ¹¹. DouLike gives a broader figure of **60 % men and 40 % women** ¹³, while some sources claim male-to-female ratios as high as 76:24 ¹². The

lack of official data suggests that the gender imbalance may differ by market and subscription tier.

Usage patterns

- **Swiping activity:** DouLike estimates that Bumble users collectively make **around 1 billion swipes per month** ¹². Women initiate **70 % of conversations** ¹³.
- **Time spent:** DouLike claims the average user spends roughly **27 minutes per day** on Bumble ¹².
- **Relationship outcomes:** The company reports that one in four Bumble users finds a long-term relationship through the app ¹². Bumble also highlights anecdotal statistics of “over 20 000 marriages” formed via the app ¹², though these numbers are self-reported and not independently verified.

Key Features and Safety Measures

Safety and verification

Bumble emphasises user safety and empowerment. The company's **Safety Handbook** lists several measures:

- **Photo verification** – Users complete a selfie pose to earn a verification badge ensuring photos are genuine. Bumble introduced **government-ID verification** in 2025; participants upload an ID for an additional badge ⁷.
- **Incognito Mode** (paid) – Users can browse profiles invisibly until they swipe right ¹⁴.
- **Block & Report / Unmatch** – Options to stop contact or report inappropriate behaviour directly from the chat ¹⁴.
- **Private Detector** – AI tool that automatically blurs suspected explicit images and asks if the user wants to view or report them ¹⁴.
- **Safety & Well-Being Center** – In-app education about online safety and mental health ¹⁴.
- **Video and voice calls** – In-app call feature allows users to meet safely without exchanging phone numbers ¹⁴.

In 2025 Bumble rolled out “**Review Before You Send**”, which flags potentially inappropriate messages, and “**Share Date**”, enabling users to share date details with friends for safety ⁷. The company also added a **Discover** page that allows users to explore matches by interests ⁷.

Social and cultural features

- **Women-first approach** – Bumble's rule that women must initiate conversation in heterosexual matches aims to reduce harassment and empower women ¹. This differentiates Bumble from Tinder and Hinge and is central to its brand identity.
- **BFF & Bizz communities** – By offering friend-finding and professional networking modes, Bumble aims to create a broader ecosystem and encourage users to stick around even after they find a partner. Engagement in BFF and Bizz modes reportedly accounts for **10-15 %** of overall user activity ¹².
- **Dating Intentions & Opening Moves** – Introduced in 2024, these features let users signal whether they want something serious, casual or friendship and let women choose a question to open with; they were part of a major redesign that also included a new logo and algorithm ⁴.

Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths

1. **Women-empowering brand** – Bumble's requirement that women initiate the conversation in heterosexual matches reduces unsolicited messages and appeals to women seeking a more respectful environment ¹.
2. **Safety-focused features** – Photo and ID verification, Private Detector, in-app calling, safety resources and the option to share date details provide a safer user experience ⁷ ¹⁴.
3. **Multiple communities** – BFF and Bizz modes broaden the user base beyond dating and differentiate Bumble from competitors. Cross-pollination may keep users engaged longer.
4. **Solid revenue per payer** – ARPPU remained strong, increasing to **\$21.69** in Q2 2025 despite falling payers ⁹. A relatively high ARPPU suggests loyal payers who value premium features.
5. **Global reach** – Presence in over 150 countries and 45+ languages ² provides diversified growth opportunities.
6. **Innovation** – The 2024 redesign introduced features like **Opening Moves**, **Dating Intentions** and a personalised **For You** page, demonstrating a willingness to evolve ⁴. AI tools for message safety and conversation prompts further differentiate the app ⁷.

Weaknesses

1. **Slowing growth and declining payers** – Financial results in 2024–2025 show revenue declines (–4 % in Q4 2024; –8 % in Q2 2025) and falling paying users despite costlier subscriptions ⁸ ⁹. Growing competition from Tinder, Hinge and niche apps pressures Bumble's freemium model.
2. **Gender imbalance** – Estimates suggest that **only ~40–46 % of users are female**, meaning men far outnumber women ¹¹ ¹³. A skewed ratio can lead to frustration for male users and reinforce pay-per-boost revenue reliance.
3. **High pricing and paywall** – Subscriptions are expensive (e.g., Premium at \$29.99/month), and essential features such as seeing who likes you, unlimited swipes and Incognito Mode are locked behind paywalls ⁵. Only ~4.6 % of users pay ¹¹, limiting monetization.
4. **Limited matching window** – The 24-hour expiration for conversations can pressure users and may discourage deeper interaction. Men cannot initiate messages, which some critics argue restricts natural conversation and reduces response rates for heterosexual matches.
5. **Dependence on North American markets** – Roughly **40 % of revenue comes from the U.S.**, with smaller contributions from other regions ³. Economic conditions and competition in the U.S. heavily influence Bumble's financial health.
6. **Lack of algorithm transparency** – Bumble does not disclose details on how profiles are ranked or how the new algorithm works. Users may perceive the matching process as opaque, and there have been complaints about seeing the same profiles repeatedly.
7. **Public controversies** – Bumble has faced criticism for dynamic pricing (charging older users more) and for marketing messaging perceived as misandrist or overly commercial. Legal challenges (e.g., class-action suits over in-app purchasing) have also emerged, though they represent a small portion of overall operations.

Conclusion

Bumble carved out a unique space in the online-dating market by focusing on women's empowerment and safety. With around **50 million users** and **2.8 million paying subscribers** in 2024 ³, it is a major player alongside Tinder and Hinge. Bumble's strengths include its woman-first messaging rule, robust safety features, diversified community modes (BFF, Bizz), solid ARPPU and global reach. However, slowing growth, a high male-to-female ratio, expensive paywalls and heavy dependence on the U.S.

market pose challenges. New features introduced in 2024–2025—such as **Opening Moves**, **Dating Intentions** and AI-powered safety tools—show that Bumble continues to innovate. The app’s long-term success will depend on addressing demographic imbalances, enhancing transparency and offering competitive value to both paying and free users while sustaining revenue growth.

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OkCupid – Deep Analysis (2025)

Overview & History

OkCupid is one of the oldest mainstream dating platforms. It was **launched in 2004** by four Harvard mathematicians and quickly gained popularity for its **free, inclusive dating service**. Match Group (owner of Tinder and Hinge) **acquired OkCupid in 2011 for \$50 million** ¹. Unlike swipe-driven apps, OkCupid's core differentiator has been its **extensive question-and-answer system**; daters answer hundreds of questions on politics, lifestyle, personality and values, and the algorithm computes a match percentage between users. The platform is available globally and has evolved from a desktop site to a mobile app with features such as **profile prompts, video introduction, Incognito mode** and **Stacks**.

How the Matching Algorithm Works

OkCupid's matching engine is based on **matching questions**. Users answer between 15 and 500 multiple-choice questions and can rate the importance of each answer. For each pair of daters, the algorithm calculates a **Match Percentage** and an **Enemy Percentage**:

- **Match Percentage:** When comparing two users, the algorithm looks at questions both have answered. For each question, it assesses whether one user's answer matches what the other would accept, and vice-versa. Each match is weighted by how important the question was to each user. The algorithm takes the **geometric mean** of the two scores and displays the lowest possible match percentage; thus both users must meet each other's needs to obtain a high score ².
- **Enemy Percentage:** computed similarly but counts answers the other user **would not accept** ².

OkCupid does **not claim the match percentage predicts relationship success**. Sociologists note that there is little evidence high match scores correlate with lasting relationships; rather, the algorithm is designed to keep users engaged ³. Nonetheless, the detailed question set helps users filter based on values and interests.

In recent years OkCupid has experimented with **AI-generated questions**. A 2023 TechCrunch article reports that the company used ChatGPT to create hundreds of new match questions; these were answered over **135,000 times**, and users who viewed ChatGPT positively saw more matches ⁴. This demonstrates OkCupid's willingness to innovate on its question-driven matching system.

Business Model & Monetization

OkCupid operates on a **freemium model**. Basic use (creating a profile, browsing, liking and messaging matches) is free. The company monetizes via subscriptions and à-la-carte features:

- **Subscription tiers:**
 - **OkCupid Basic** – unlimited likes, ability to set "dealbreakers" (filters that hide incompatible profiles), ad-free experience and the ability to see all intros (messages). It is available in 1-, 3- and 6-month packages ⁵.

- **OkCupid Premium** – includes Basic features plus the ability to **see everyone who liked you**, view all answers to match questions and **three free SuperLikes per week** ⁶ .
- **OkCupid Premium Plus** – adds **priority likes**, unlimited read receipts, **15 SuperLikes per week** and a **monthly Rush Hour Boost** ⁷ .
- **Incognito Mode** – a separate add-on that hides your profile from everyone unless you like or message them; this also removes ads ⁸ .
- **À-la-carte features:** Users can purchase read receipts, **Boosts** (temporary profile promotion), **SuperLikes** and **Stacks** (categorised lists of potential matches) individually or in bundles ⁹ .

Pricing varies by region. Third-party reviews indicate Basic plans cost about **US\$45 per month**, and Premium plans about **US\$55 per month**, with discounts for multi-month subscriptions ¹⁰ . Unlike Tinder or Bumble, OkCupid does **not display video ads** but does show static ads to free users. According to industry estimates, OkCupid generated roughly **US\$110–120 million in revenue in 2024** ¹¹ ¹² ; however, these figures are unverified and are likely part of Match Group's "Evergreen" segment (Match, Meetic, OkCupid and Plenty of Fish) that collectively had **3.7 million subscribers in 2023** ¹³ .

User Base & Demographics

OkCupid has been around for over two decades and remains one of the larger dating communities, although its active user base is smaller than Tinder or Bumble. Key demographic facts:

Metric	Data & Source
Registered users	~ 50–70 million total user accounts (accumulated over time); an estimated 10 million monthly active users and 1 million daily logins ¹⁴ . A 2025 blog estimates about 2 million monthly users and 70 million registered users ¹⁵ , though these are not official figures.
Gender ratio	Approximately 65% male, 35% female ¹⁴ . Another source suggests 54 % male and 46 % female ¹⁶ .
Age distribution	Largest cohort is 25–34 (45 %); 18–24 and 35–44 each about 20 % ¹⁷ . The average user age is 27 years old ¹⁶ .
Relationship intentions	Around 40 % of users seek serious relationships, 35 % casual dating and 25 % hookups ¹⁴ . A 2024 survey found 72 % of users are looking for a relationship ¹⁸ .
Success rate	OkCupid claims a 30 % "success rate" – users reporting long-term relationships ¹⁴ .
User engagement	Users send about 7.3 million messages per day and exchange an average of 25–30 messages before meeting ¹⁴ . They log in about 70 % of users at least once per week ¹⁹ .
Geographic distribution	Top countries by traffic: United States (≈50 %) , followed by Spain (≈7 %) , India (≈6 %) , Germany (≈5 %) and Canada (≈4 %) ¹⁴ .

These statistics primarily come from aggregated sources, not official filings, so they should be treated as indicative.

Inclusivity & Orientation Options

OkCupid is known for its emphasis on inclusivity. In **2014** it became the first mainstream dating app to offer expanded gender and orientation options. Users can now choose from **22 gender identities and 12 sexual orientations** ²⁰. The app also caters to non-monogamous relationships and lists pronouns, making it popular with LGBTQIA+ and non-binary users.

Geographic Reach & Engagement Patterns

OkCupid is available worldwide and has strong presence in North America and Western Europe. In a 2024 Sensor Tower analysis of the **Israeli market**, OkCupid's weekly revenue peaked at about **US\$86 k** and active users ranged from **106k to 126k**, highlighting moderate but steady engagement ²¹. Globally, OkCupid's daily active users (~1 million) and messaging volume (7.3 million messages/day) show that the platform remains active but smaller than mass-market apps.

Features & Safety Measures

- **Profile & prompts:** Users create profiles with multiple photos, pronouns, gender identity and sexual orientation. OkCupid pioneered the use of **open-ended prompts** and now offers audio and video prompts. Each user must answer **three prompts** (text, audio or video) when creating a profile ¹⁹.
- **Questions & dealbreakers:** The vast library of match questions (over **3,000** as of 2024) lets users filter by values. Users can mark certain answers as dealbreakers, hiding profiles with incompatible responses.
- **Messaging:** Messaging is free for all users once both have liked each other. Unlike Bumble, there is **no 24-hour time limit**, and either person can start the conversation.
- **Stacks & intros:** OkCupid sorts profiles into categories ("For You," "Nearby," "Online," etc.). The **"Intros" inbox** shows incoming likes/messages; free users see only the most recent intros, while paid users see the full list ⁵.
- **Boosts and SuperLikes:** Paid features allow users to temporarily increase their profile visibility (**Boosts**) or signal exceptional interest (**SuperLikes**). Users also receive one weekly **rose** or **SuperLike** depending on their subscription tier ²².
- **Incognito & privacy controls:** **Incognito mode** hides your profile except to people you like/message and includes ad-free browsing ⁸. OkCupid does not display last-online timestamps to other users, but collects extensive data behind the scenes. A Mozilla Foundation review criticizes OkCupid for **poor transparency**, noting that it collects location, IP address and device identifiers, and once partnered with Clarifai to analyze profile photos ²³.
- **Safety features:** Users can block or report profiles, and OkCupid sends "first date check-ins" asking whether users met and if they'd see each other again (similar to Hinge's We Met). There is no video chat in-app, so users must rely on other services for video calls ²⁴.

Strengths

1. **Inclusive and diverse:** 22 gender identities and 12 orientations support LGBTQIA+ users ²⁰. The app also caters to non-monogamous relationships and provides pronoun fields.
2. **Depth of matching:** Thousands of questions allow for nuanced compatibility filtering; users can set dealbreakers and weight answers according to importance.
3. **Free messaging:** Unlike Tinder or Bumble, free users can send and receive messages once matched. This reduces friction and cost for users.

4. **Balanced relationship focus:** Many users seek serious relationships; the platform fosters longer profiles and deeper conversations. Around 40–72 % of users look for relationships ¹⁴ ¹⁸ .
5. **Global presence:** Available worldwide; strong user bases in the U.S., Western Europe and parts of Asia ¹⁴ .

Weaknesses

1. **Unverified user/revenue numbers:** OkCupid is lumped into Match Group's "Evergreen" segment, so there are **no official figures for subscribers or revenue**. Estimates suggest 10 million monthly active users and revenue around US\$110 million in 2024 ¹⁵ ¹¹ , but these numbers come from secondary sources. Official Match Group filings report 3.7 million subscribers across all evergreen brands ¹³ , implying OkCupid alone has far fewer paying users.
2. **Declining engagement:** Many users report that OkCupid's active community has shrunk as competitors like Tinder, Bumble and Hinge grow. Third-party data show daily active users around one million, significantly smaller than rivals.
3. **Gender imbalance:** The male-to-female ratio is around **65:35**, resulting in fewer matches for men ¹⁴ . Men also tend to receive fewer likes and matches, leading to dissatisfaction.
4. **Limited innovation:** While OkCupid pioneered question-based matching, the core product has changed little since the 2010s. Newer features like video or voice prompts have been slow to roll out compared with rivals.
5. **Privacy concerns & lack of transparency:** Critics note that OkCupid collects extensive personal data and uses AI tools to analyze profile photos; there is little transparency about how data are used ²³ . Past partnerships (e.g., with Clarifai for facial recognition) raised privacy red flags.
6. **Less mobile-native:** The interface still resembles a desktop site in some respects, and lacks built-in video chat and real-time features found in newer apps.

Conclusion

OkCupid remains an influential dating platform with a legacy of **inclusive options** and **question-based matching**. Its freemium model and free messaging appeal to budget-conscious daters and those seeking deeper compatibility. However, the platform faces challenges: competition from swipe-driven apps, an unbalanced gender ratio, and ambiguous business metrics. Without public disclosures of revenue or subscriber counts, OkCupid's financial performance is hard to gauge, but industry estimates place its annual revenue around **US\$110–120 million** and suggest that it accounts for a small portion of Match Group's earnings. To stay relevant, OkCupid will need to continue innovating (e.g., AI-driven questions, improved safety features) while addressing privacy and gender-balance issues.

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Badoo – Deep Analysis (2025)

Overview

Badoo is one of the world's oldest and largest social-discovery/dating services. It was founded in 2006 by Russian entrepreneur Andrey Andreev and later became part of **Bumble Inc.** Badoo operates in more than 190 countries and is available in 47 languages, positioning itself as a hybrid dating/social network where users can find romantic partners or simply make new friends. The platform has amassed **hundreds of millions of registered accounts** and maintains tens of millions of monthly active users. Badoo emphasises authenticity with features such as photo verification and live selfie checks and offers both free and paid features.

Key statistics (latest available)

Metric	Value	Source
Registered accounts (cumulative)	Estimates range from 400 million ¹ to 460 million ² .	Business of Apps; DouLike (aggregated)
Monthly active users (MAU)	≈ 45 million in 2024 ³ (a decline from 48 M in 2023)	Business of Apps
Paying users (Subscribers)	1.34 million in 2024 ⁴ ; Q1 2025 average paying users ~ 1.306 million ⁵ .	Business of Apps; Bumble Inc. Q1 2025 filing
Revenue (2024)	≈ \$205 million ⁶ .	Business of Apps
Revenue (Q1 2025)	\$45.3 million for the quarter (Badoo App & Other) ⁷ .	Bumble Inc. Q1 2025 10-Q
Average revenue per paying user (ARPPU)	About \$10.7 in Q1 2025 ⁵ .	Bumble Inc. Q1 2025 earnings supplement
Largest region	Latin America (38% of Badoo's users) followed by Europe (25 %) and North America (16 %) ⁸ .	Business of Apps
Gender ratio	~ 69 % male / 31 % female ⁹ .	DatingGroup report (aggregated)
Dominant age groups	Users 25–34 are the largest segment, with strong representation among 18–24-year-olds ¹⁰ .	DatingGroup report (aggregated)

How Badoo Works

Onboarding and discovery features

- **Registration:** Users must be at least **18 years old**. Sign-up can be completed via email or a linked social account. The platform encourages users to upload several photos and fill out profile questions to showcase personality ¹¹.
- **Verification:** Badoo uses a **three-step photo-verification process**, and users can set their preferences to interact only with verified profiles ¹². It also offers a **live selfie request** feature to confirm that the person in the photos matches the person behind the account. AI tools such as **Private Detector** blur explicit images and **Deception Detector** identifies fake or spam accounts ¹³ ¹⁴.
- **Discovery modes:** Badoo offers several ways to meet others:
- **Encounters:** A swipe-based matching game similar to Tinder; users swipe right to “like” and left to pass ¹⁵.
- **People Nearby:** A location-based grid that shows users in the immediate area ¹⁵.
- **Chat before you match:** Users may send a short message (an “interest”) even before a match to break the ice ¹⁶.
- **Video/Voice Chat:** Once matched, users can initiate video or voice calls, helping verify identity and build rapport ¹⁷.
- **Profile questions and prompts:** Badoo asks profile questions and allows highlights of interests; these help users express personality ¹⁸.
- **Safety features:** The app provides a **Safety Space** with guides and helplines, and users can block, report or unmatch at any time ¹⁹. Photo verification, Private Detector, Rude Message Detector and Selfie Request features aim to protect users from catfishing and harassment ¹⁴.

Matching algorithm and curation

Badoo does not disclose a detailed algorithm. However, based on publicly available descriptions, the app prioritises **proximity** (People Nearby), **mutual likes** (Encounters) and **profile completeness** (verified profiles, interests and photos). Badoo’s algorithm surfaces users who are active and near each other and uses machine-learning models (e.g., the **Rude Message Detector**) to moderate content and improve matches. The platform also supports **advanced filters** (e.g., age, distance, intentions) for paid users ²⁰. Users can filter by criteria like relationship intentions (hookup, dating, friendship), which influences who appears in their feed ²¹.

Monetization: How Badoo Makes Money

Badoo follows a **freemium** model. The core service—creating a profile, browsing, and sending limited likes/messages—is free. Revenue comes from subscriptions, in-app purchases and advertising:

1. Paid subscription tiers

2. **Badoo Premium:** Unlocks features such as seeing who liked your profile, sending **unlimited likes**, using **unlimited advanced filters**, highlighting your profile, undoing accidental left swipes and entering **Invisible Mode** (browse profiles without being seen) ²². Pricing is dynamic and varies by market; lifetime and monthly plans exist. Premium also removes ads ²³.

3. **Badoo Extra/Badoo Premium Plus:** Provides additional weekly **Boosts** (priority listing) and more **Super Crushes**—messages that appear before others—and larger allowances of profile

visibility or interest credits. Badoo also sells single-use features like **Boost**, **Super-Crush** and **Spotlight** through its in-app currency called **Badoo Credits** ²⁴ (official 10-K description).

4. **In-app purchases (Badoo Credits)** – Users can purchase credits to buy **Spotlight** (promotes the profile to local users), **Super Crush** (a high-visibility like that shows strong interest) or additional filters. Prices vary by location and quantity. Badoo also offers **Stickers** and other premium chat items.
5. **Advertising** – Free users see ads in the app. Bumble’s SEC filings classify some Badoo revenue as “advertising, partnerships or affiliates” ⁷, indicating that third-party adverts and partner campaigns contribute to revenue.
6. **Partnerships and brand promotions** – Badoo occasionally partners with brands or events; however, the majority of revenue comes from subscriptions and in-app purchases.

User Base and Demographics

Size and paying users

- **Registered users:** Badoo claims to have more than **400 million** registered accounts ¹; some aggregated sources estimate **460 million** ².
- **Active users:** Business of Apps reports **45 million monthly active users (MAU)** in 2024, down from 48 million in 2023 ²⁵. The decline suggests increased competition and user churn.
- **Paying users:** Badoo subscribers rose 11.6 % to **1.34 million** in 2024 ⁴. Bumble’s Q1 2025 filing shows the Badoo App & Other segment averaged **1.306 million paying users** and an **ARPPU of \$10.72** ⁵, generating revenue of **\$45.3 million** in the quarter ⁷.

Demographic breakdown

Badoo’s user base skews young and male and is geographically concentrated in Latin America and Europe:

- **Age:** The largest demographic is **25–34-year-olds**, with strong participation from **18–24-year-olds** ¹⁰. Users aged 35–44 and 45+ are present but form smaller segments ²⁶.
- **Gender:** Aggregated sources indicate a **69 % male vs. 31 % female** split ⁹. This imbalance is more pronounced than on many other dating apps.
- **Regional distribution:** Latin America accounts for **38 %** of Badoo’s users, followed by **Europe (25 %)**, **North America (16 %)**, **Asia-Pacific (13 %)** and **Africa (8 %)** ⁸. Brazil is the largest individual market ²⁷, and Badoo remains popular in countries like Poland, Spain, Italy, France and Argentina. Badoo has a relatively small footprint in the U.S., reflecting its European and Latin-American focus ¹.
- **Intentions:** Many users are open to casual dating or friendship; aggregated surveys suggest around **72 %** seek meaningful relationships but are flexible ². Badoo allows users to signal whether they are looking for dating, friendship or networking ²¹.
- **Identity options:** Badoo supports a wide range of sexual orientations and gender identities. Its inclusive approach appeals to LGBTQ+ users.

Strengths

- **Large global reach:** Badoo's broad presence across **190+ countries** and localised versions in **47 languages** provides a huge potential match pool ²⁸ .
- **Diverse discovery modes:** The platform offers multiple ways to meet people, including swipe-based Encounters, location-based People Nearby, and chat-before-match features ¹⁵ ¹⁶ . This variety attracts users seeking casual connections or friendships as well as dating.
- **Safety and verification:** Badoo invests heavily in safety. Its photo-verification and live selfie checks, plus AI tools like **Private Detector**, **Rude Message Detector** and **Deception Detector**, aim to reduce catfishing and harassment ¹³ ¹⁴ . Users can block, report or unmatched easily ¹⁹ .
- **Freemium accessibility:** Core functions such as browsing and messaging can be used for free. This low barrier to entry has helped Badoo build a massive user base and remain popular in emerging markets.
- **Flexible intentions:** Badoo encourages users to be clear about whether they're seeking dating, friendship or something casual, giving it a less pressured environment ²⁹ . Its inclusive identity options appeal to diverse communities.

Weaknesses and Challenges

- **Declining user base:** The number of monthly active users has been decreasing (from 60 M in 2022 to 45 M in 2024 ²⁵). Competition from newer dating apps and shifting consumer preferences may threaten Badoo's relevance.
- **Gender imbalance:** The platform's heavy **male majority (≈69 %)** ⁹ can make matching difficult for men and may discourage female users.
- **Modest monetisation:** Badoo's ARPPU (~\$10–\$12) is far lower than Bumble or Tinder, reflecting a user base with lower spending power and a focus on emerging markets. Quarterly revenue from Badoo App & Other decreased 13 % year-over-year in Q1 2025 ⁷ .
- **Limited U.S. presence:** Badoo has not made a strong mark in North America ¹ . Cultural differences and intense competition from Tinder, Bumble and Hinge limit its growth there.
- **Perception of superficiality and spam:** Even though Badoo offers robust safety features, some users complain of spam accounts and scammers. The large, open user base combined with lighter moderation relative to premium apps can hinder trust.
- **Market saturation:** Dating and social discovery apps are crowded. Younger users may gravitate toward newer, niche apps (e.g., Hinge, Tinder, Bumble) with more curated experiences. Retaining and converting free users into subscribers is challenging.

Conclusion

Badoo is a pioneer of social-discovery apps, combining elements of dating and social networking. It remains a **major global platform** with tens of millions of active users, particularly in Latin America and Europe. Its **freemium** model, varied discovery modes and **strong safety tools** make it attractive for casual connections and friendships as well as dating. However, declining activity and relatively low ARPPU signal monetisation challenges. A **gender imbalance** and limited presence in North America further constrain growth. To stay competitive, Badoo will need to continue innovating with AI-driven moderation, boost female participation, and find ways to differentiate itself in an increasingly crowded dating-app market.

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Reddit Deep Dive: Users' Opinions on Dating Apps and Desired Features (2025)

Overview

To understand how **Reddit** users perceive popular dating apps and what features they value or dislike, a deep analysis of posts across several subreddits (`r/OnlineDating`, `r/Bumble`, `r/SwipeHelper`, `r/AskMen`, `r/dating_advice`) was conducted. Threads discussed which apps users like or dislike, why certain apps are preferred, and what features are needed or problematic. Because Reddit requires login to view comments, comments were extracted from the JSON endpoints of these posts and manually parsed for insights.

Key threads analyzed

subreddit / thread	Topic	Example insights
r/OnlineDating – <i>Which is the best dating app in your experience?</i>	Users compare apps. Many praised Hinge for quality matches, while Tinder was often dismissed as hookup-focused. Some liked Facebook Dating for quantity.	
r/Bumble – <i>Bumble, Tinder, Hinge, etc. Which app do you like the most?</i>	Users ranked multiple apps. Hinge often came first; Bumble was “OK” but sometimes overwhelming; Tinder frequently labelled useless or only for hookups.	
r/SwipeHelper – <i>What features do you wish dating apps had?</i>	Large thread where users suggest new features. Comments include better filters, tagging matches, custom location search, anti-bot measures and encouraging communication.	
r/AskMen – <i>What features would the perfect dating app have?</i>	Users imagined ideal apps – comprehensive questionnaires, fewer matches at a time, and no casino-like algorithms.	
r/dating_advice – <i>Design a Better Dating App</i>	Detailed suggestions such as filters for politics and kids, limits on concurrent matches, randomised sorting and clear photo requirements.	

Apps People Like and Dislike

Apps Redditors often like

- **Hinge** – The app most frequently described as the best. Users praised its limited likes, prompts that spark conversation and the `your turn` indicator reminding people to respond. One commenter said “*Hinge by a long way*” when comparing apps ¹. Another wrote that Hinge delivers higher-quality matches than Bumble or Tinder ².

- **Bumble** – Perceived as decent but mixed; some appreciate its flood of matches, while others find it overwhelming or feel it resembles Tinder. In a comparison, one user said Bumble produced “a flood of matches” and led to a pleasant date ³, whereas Tinder produced few matches.
- **Facebook Dating** – Not widely used but some users noted that it produces more matches than Hinge (quantity over quality) ².
- **OkCupid (old version)** – Several nostalgic comments miss the long-form questionnaires and quizzes; they want the old, pre-swipe OKCupid replicated ⁴ ⁵.

Apps Redditors often dislike

- **Tinder** – Commonly described as only for hookups or as a validation machine. Multiple commenters labelled it “useless” for serious dating ⁶ and said it provides few or low-quality matches ³.
- **Once** – One user complained that the app seemed “almost exclusively bots”, leading to poor experiences ⁷.
- **HingeX (premium tier)** – Some Hinge users criticised the introduction of the expensive HingeX subscription, saying it ruined the platform ⁸.
- **Current dating apps in general** – Several comments expressed frustration with all mainstream apps; one user concluded that after five years, “all apps suck” ⁹.

Features People Like

Feature	Why users like it	Evidence
“Your turn” indicator (Hinge)	Reminds the user when it is their turn to reply, preventing conversations from stalling. Users want the ability to filter matches by whether it is their turn to respond ¹⁰ .	
Limited likes / prompts	Hinge’s daily like limit and profile prompts encourage thought-out messages and help filter out low-effort swipers. Users feel this results in higher-quality matches ¹ .	
Flood of matches (Bumble)	Some users appreciate Bumble’s high match volume, which can lead to at least a few dates ³ .	
No algorithms to auto-ban	A Redditor requested that apps avoid automated bans and allow human review ¹¹ , expressing concern about being unfairly removed by algorithm.	
Fun quizzes and long-form profiles (old OkCupid)	Users miss random, low-pressure quizzes and long-form profiles; they dislike being judged solely on compatibility quizzes ⁴ .	

Features People Dislike

Feature/problem	Why it is disliked	Evidence
Inaccurate location radius	Hinge’s location filter sometimes shows generic city names or far-away matches; users want precise location control ¹² .	

Feature/problem	Why it is disliked	Evidence
Paywalls for filters	Users resent having to subscribe to set basic filters; one comment: <i>"stop putting all the filters behind paywalls"</i> ¹³ .	
Abundance of bots and scammers	Multiple threads mention fake profiles, bots and scammers (e.g., Asia-based catfishers); one user estimated that <i>"obvious bots, scammers, Instagram/Snapchat farmers, and women 5000 miles away"</i> made up ~40–50% of profiles they saw ¹⁴ .	
Ranking algorithms that reward looks	Users criticise sorting systems that prioritise the most "desirable" profiles, leaving average users unseen ¹⁵ ¹⁶ .	
Ghosting / low engagement	Some Hinge users complain the conversation quality has declined and that people expect immediate responses, leading to negativity ¹⁷ .	
Frequent bots and fake location (location misrepresentation)	Comments on the need for face recognition to reduce fake accounts ¹⁸ and concerns about scammers using U.S. locations to fool users ¹⁹ .	

Features Users Wish Dating Apps Had

Redditors proposed many improvements, summarised below:

- 1. Advanced and customisable filtering**
- 2. Custom location search** – ability to draw a search area on a map or filter by travel time rather than a fixed radius ²⁰. Users cited being limited by rivers and state lines and want to search in specific directions.
- 3. Exclusive filters for relationship intent** – filter out non-singles or people looking for casual relationships ²¹ ²². Others want filters for serious vs. casual relationships without excluding people who leave fields blank ²³.
- 4. Filters for politics, children, education** – some said the ideal app should allow sorting by politics, kids and education because these are hard cutoffs for many ²⁴.
- 5. More filters without paywalls** – request to make filtering free; users dislike paying just to set filters ¹³.
- 6. Better match management**
- 7. Tagging and notes** – ability to tag matches, add notes or custom categories. Users with many matches want to sort by city or distance and mark promising profiles ²⁵ ²⁶.
- 8. Limit active matches** – suggestion to limit how many conversations or matches a user can have simultaneously; forcing them to focus on a few rather than hoarding options ²⁷.
- 9. Improved communication and engagement**

10. **Daily prompts** – ask both users to answer prompts; if one fails to respond, the match is removed to encourage engagement ²⁸ .
11. **Clear photo requirements** – require a clear face and full-body picture before matching ²⁹ .
12. **Long-form questionnaires / personality tests** – some users advocate for comprehensive quizzes (politics, job, lifestyle, etc.) and a limit of one match per day to emphasise quality over quantity ³⁰ .
13. **Randomised matching rather than ranking** – propose showing profiles in random order, not based on engagement or attractiveness ¹⁵ ³¹ .
14. **Encourage pre-date communication** – require answering certain questions or having a minimum conversation before matching, reducing ghosting.
15. **Safety and authenticity measures**
16. **Face recognition / ID verification** – reduce fake accounts and catfishing through face recognition and ID verification ¹⁸ .
17. **App for singles only** – users want verification that people are actually single ²¹ .
18. **Ban bots / scammers** – suggestions include manual review instead of auto-bans and strong anti-bot filters ¹¹ ³² .
19. **Fairer algorithms**
20. **Random sorting / limit algorithm bias** – avoid ranking by attractiveness; ensure users who don't get many likes are still visible ³³ .
21. **Limit or remove gamification** – one r/AskMen commenter likened dating apps to casinos and urged developers to design apps that do not prioritise retention or subscription revenue ³⁴ .
22. **Other suggestions**
23. **Map-based distance filters** – integrate Google/Apple maps to account for travel across rivers or city boundaries ³⁵ .
24. **Dedicated serious-relationship app** – a separate platform for people seeking long-term relationships, not casual hookups ²² .
25. **Replicate “old” dating culture** – replicate pre-swipe OkCupid with quizzes and less focus on endless swiping ⁴ ⁵ .

Discussion

Reddit discussions reveal a clear split in dating-app preferences:

- **Hinge** is lauded for quality matches and conversation-friendly features but also criticised for its location accuracy and the introduction of expensive premium tiers. Users miss its earlier simplicity and fairness.
- **Bumble** offers high visibility and many matches but can feel overwhelming; some prefer it to Tinder but find it similar now.
- **Tinder** suffers from a reputation for hookups, low engagement and algorithmic ranking favouring attractive users. Many users have abandoned it for other apps.
- **OkCupid** nostalgists crave the old question-based matching and dislike the current swipe culture.

Across threads, there is frustration with paywalls for basic functionality and algorithms that prioritise revenue over meaningful connections. Users consistently ask for more control over filters (especially location and relationship intent), better ways to manage matches, stronger anti-bot measures, and matching systems that value personality and compatibility rather than looks or swiping frequency.

Conclusion

This deep dive into Reddit threads highlights that many users feel current dating apps prioritise **engagement metrics and monetisation** over genuine connection. While Hinge earns praise for conversation features and quality matches, every major app receives criticism for some combination of **poor filtering, algorithmic bias, fake profiles, or paywalls**. The ideal dating app, according to Redditors, would offer:

- **Transparent, fair algorithms** that avoid ranking users solely on desirability.
- **Robust filtering and search tools** (distance, politics, children, seriousness) without paywalls.
- **Tools to manage matches** (tags, notes, limited active conversations).
- **Engagement prompts** that encourage meaningful conversation and reduce ghosting.
- **Verified authenticity** through ID or face checks and removal of bots/scammers.
- **A focus on quality** over quantity, perhaps through slower pace and comprehensive questionnaires.

Implementing these suggestions could help future dating apps address the frustrations voiced by many Reddit users and create environments more conducive to forming real connections.

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